The Wheel of Killing of Glorious Great Vajrabhairava

Mahāśrībhairavavajracakramāraṇanāma · Toh 1984 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་རྡོ་རྗེ་འཇིགས་བྱེད་ཆེན་པའོ་གཞན་དོན་ལ་

The Wheel of Killing of Glorious Great Vajra Terrifier, known in Sanskrit as Mahāśrībhairavavajracakramāraṇanāma and in Tibetan under a title beginning Dpal rdo rje 'jigs byed, is a short tantric ritual manual belonging to the cycle of Vajrabhairava, the wrathful buffalo-headed form associated with Yamāntaka, the conqueror of death. After paying homage to Vajrasattva and bowing to the deity who displays intense wrath to subdue the wicked, the author explains that the text sets out a "wheel of killing," a fierce rite aimed at those who harm the Three Jewels, revile the guru, violate or attack the tantric pledges, reject the Great Vehicle, or slander the mantras and tantras, with the stated aim of seizing and liberating them. It stresses that the practitioner must first complete the approach phase of mantra recitation before undertaking such an activity, reflecting the tantric view that wrathful rites are only valid for one already established in the deity's practice. The work is Toh 1984 in the Tengyur, where it is preserved among the tantra commentaries and ritual texts connected with the Yamāri and Vajrabhairava tradition.

In the Indian language: Mahāśrībhairavavajracakramāraṇanāma. In the Tibetan language: The Wheel of Killing of Glorious Great Vajra Terrifier (Vajrabhairava). Homage to Glorious Vajrasattva.

Having abandoned the obscurations of what is to be known and the rest,
and having taken all characteristics into your mind,
by showing the manner of intense wrath
I bow to you who subdue the wicked.

Those who harm the Three Jewels, who revile the guru,
who bear hatred toward the sacred pledges and torment the pledge-holders,
who refute the Great Vehicle,
who slander the mantras and the tantras:
in order to seize them and liberate them through killing,
the wheel of killing is here made clear.

First one should complete the approach (the recitation phase) and then engage in the act of killing; otherwise one should not. The yogī should be

endowed with the empowerments, with unimpaired pledges, and firm in the nonconceptual discipline; he should be pure, respectful toward the guru, tamed, single-mindedly devoted to the teaching, and endowed with diligence. Dwelling in a great charnel ground, he should completely perform the offerings to the Tathāgatas and the rest, and, by means of the mantra that is pure by its intrinsic nature, he should meditate that all phenomena are without self.

Then, upon the syllable yaṃ, there arises, and there from dhīḥ one generates Mañjuśrī; this is the cause. In his heart, upon a sun disc, one generates Great Vajra Terrifier just as he is; this is the result. Draw the wheel of wisdom into him. If the three sattvas are present, as examined, then by reciting the mantras with all their limbs unimpaired, one brings them to their full measure. Here one should begin the act of the wheel of killing.

If one asks why: because its application is the principal one, it alone is taught. Here, the yogī, whose trust in the ritual is firm and whose mantras are complete in number, should gather the following, since they possess the power of dependent origination: cloth from a charnel ground, poison, mustard seed, salt, neem, a maddening substance, the leftovers of what crows have eaten, Vairocana, the fruit of the datura, white chalk, flour, powder of human bone, charcoal from a burned corpse, charnel ground ash, thread from a corpse, corpse hair, a crow's feather quill, a skull of one who died by a cut-off lineage, earth from a charnel ground, earth from a crossroads, earth from a one-legged tree, earth from two riverbanks, earth from a place with a single lingam, earth from an anthill, earth from a king's gate, a dagger made of human bone, and sharp thorns of a malignant tree.

The yogī, endowed with the application of the buffalo face, facing south, should recite the secret mantra over these substances. On the charnel ground cloth he should take a foundation from white chalk and flour. Then he should purify the poison, mustard seed, salt, neem, the maddening substance, the crows' leftovers, Vairocana, charnel ground ash and datura fruit, smear them on, and stretch the cloth out.

Then, on a cloth of half a cubit, he should draw the sixteen-compartment wheel of Great Vajra Terrifier. With a string, first he should mark the cloth in half, then below that mark the intermediate points by twos. Behind that, with the first two of the lines laid at the end on the foundation, he should set one on each side, leaving it. Around it he should make three circuits: with the first, turning around half, he makes nine petals. With the middle one, turning

around half of that, he makes twelve compartments. With the last, he goes around the edge of the first and makes it a single one. To place the wheel of mantra upon that wheel of substance, he should know the mantras by the eight groups and the one, and draw them. He should mix datura poison, neem and the ash of a burned corpse, make it into ink, and draw with the quill of a crow's wing feather.

The mudrā and mantra for the drawing should be those of the pledge of Yamāntaka. Join the two hands palm to palm, join the tips of the two middle fingers, cross the two ring fingers, join the two little fingers likewise, bend the two index fingers, and join the two thumbs evenly. The mantra is:

oṃ hrīḥ ṣṭṛḥ vikṛtāna na ma ma śatrūṃ māraya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ

In the sixteen-compartment wheel one should arrange the thirty-two syllables together with the name of the one to be accomplished (the victim). In the first compartment, place the seed of wind in the center. In front of it, place the fifth of the sixth. On the right, the fifth of the sixth, with the eleventh of the first joined above it. Behind, place the third of the fifth. On the left, the single syllable, with the eleventh of the first joined above it. In the second, the first: the seed of fire, with the second of the first joined below. In the second, the third of the third, joined below the first. In the third, place the third of the eighth. In the fourth, the third of the fifth, with the tenth of the first joined above. In the fifth, the second of the seventh, with the fifth of the first joined below. In the sixth, place the fifth of the fourth. In the seventh, the first of the seventh, with the thirteenth joined above. In the eighth, the fifth of the fifth, joined above the third of the first. In the ninth, place the second of the seventh. In the tenth, place the seed of wind. In the eleventh, place the first of the third doubled. In the twelfth, the fifth of the fifth, with the third of the first joined above. In the empty space within the middle, insert the name of the one to be accomplished between the two raṃ. At the outer edge, joining the mantra of ten syllables as it is known with the name, circle it around. Surround it with eight hūṃ.

Having drawn it thus, endowed with the samādhi of the Great Wrathful One and with emanation, one should perform the separation of the victim from his deity according to the oral instruction. Placing the victim in the maṇḍala of wind, one recites:

oṃ yamarāja sadomeya yamedoruṇayodaya yadayonirayakṣeya yakṣeya canirāmaya ākarṣaya jaḥ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ

Or one should join it with the ten-syllable mantra. By reciting thus, a ray of light like an iron hook seizes the victim from the heart, and he comes and should be made to enter the wheel. When his entering has become clear, one folds the cloth up.

Then, with the seven beginning with the charnel ground earth, with Vairocana, with vajra water and with the charnel ground charcoal, one makes an image of the victim eight finger-widths in measure, and inserts the wheel into its heart. One drives daggers into five places, and sharp thorns into all the joints. Then one places it between two skulls, binds it with a thread of hair, and with the two kinds of mantra wheel, in the order of the oral instruction, one kills it, whether by all four yogas or by any one of them, in due order.

Its secret mantra is the one taught above, interspersed with māraya.

Then, from those seven earths, one makes a figure of Yama one cubit in measure, with a contorted face, two-armed and one-faced, holding in his hands a sword and a noose, making the threatening gesture with the forefinger, naked, with his hair hanging loose. Into his heart one inserts the skull cup. At midnight or at midday one digs very deep in the charnel ground, and there one generates the samaya being of Karma Yama. Into it one draws the wisdom being and makes the two nondual. Having pleased it by presenting offerings and torma, one sets it head toward the south and face down, and presses it down with the mantra taught above interspersed with staṃbhanaya.

Returning home, with an intensely wrathful mind, one recites the ten-syllable mantra, and the victim will die without doubt. If one takes it out and washes it, he will be released.

By whatever small virtue there is
in having composed this sequence of rites
of the wheel of killing, done to protect the teaching,
may beings cross beyond saṃsāra
and attain that very Great Wrathful One.

Composed by Lalita, complete.

Translator's Notes

• The mantra syllables are given as the Tibetan spells them. The instructions for placing the syllables in the compartments refer to a coded system of mantra letters (for example "the fifth of the sixth"), and I have rendered them literally. The "three sattvas" are the samayasattva, jñānasattva and samādhisattva. "The wheel of mantra" and "the wheel of substance" are the

two diagrams used in the rite.
• The Tibetan reads "spung ste bkrus na," where "spung" (to heap up) makes little sense. It is most likely a slip for "phyung" (taken out), giving "if one takes it out and washes it." I have translated that reading. The whole procedure is a wrathful rite for protecting the teaching, as the closing verse states. "Karma Yama," the Yama of activity, is taken as the activity form invoked in this Yamāntaka cycle.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.